

FESTIVAL

The Tunes of Change

It is not an institution that is housed in a building of concrete and mortar. SPIC MACAY is one of the finest movements of India that has infused the love for music, dance and the country's culture in the youth. Be it San Francisco or a village near Udaipur, this mass awakening has made the youth take notice and be proud of their heritage. What is different is that the artistes take an active part in this movement. "The organisation has not just projected artistes but art as well. Artistes come and go but the message should remain the same," says santoor maestro, Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma, who has encouraged SPIC MACAY through his many

performances. Some of them are amazed by the awakening among the audiences. "I went to a remote school in Chipra Mahu village near Kanpur. I thought they would ask me to sing *bhajans*. To my surprise, they wanted to hear classical music. There is a thirst for good music. We need to quench it," says vocalist Sunanda Sharma. In its 31st year now, SPIC MACAY is beginning its month-long (till February) Fest 2009 series in Delhi and in 300 towns across the country. The performances include Pandit Birju Maharaj, Pandit Vishwamohan Bhatt, Rashid Khan, N. Rajam, M. Venkatesh Kumar among others.

The fest comprises various aspects of our rich heritage like classic films of directors like Satyajit Ray, Akira Kurosawa, Charlie Chaplin and many more. There will be folk forms from Rajasthan by Rahmat Khan Langa, walks to historical sites and craft workshops by Shanti Devi (on Madhubani paintings), Sentila Yanger (Naga weaving), Karuna Chitrakar (Patwa painting), Anis Siddiqui (Calligraphy). The programmes, to be held in schools and colleges, are dedicated to noted painter Manjit Bawa and vocalist Pandit Ram Ashreya Jha.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

PANDIT BIRJU MAHARAJ (LEFT);
SANTOOR MAESTRO SHAHID PARVEZ



SUPRAVAS



RAVI KUMAR

ART EXHIBITION

Power of TEN

Dus Mahavidyas or ten creative forces brings together 10 contemporary women artists in a show conceived and curated by Ravi Kumar. The show features the works of Shobha Broota, Saba Hasan, Kavita Jaiswal, Sanjeeta Gupta, Arpana Caur, Jaya Ganguly, Seema Kohli, Gina Brezini, Shanta Rao and Pooja Iranna. "I have selected 10 amazing women, 10 goddesses of creative expression; artists as diverse and unique in their creativity as the expression of the divine feminine itself," says Kumar. Brezini's Photopainting series is a contemplation on art and the artist with some thought-provoking works featuring artists M.F. Husain and Shubha Mudgal as the subjects. Rao's inkjet works and the representation of man-made structures by Iranna come full circle in one of the most exciting exhibitions. Till February 7 at Gallery Time and Space, Bangalore.

by Nirmala Ravindran